

Problem Set 1 Solutions

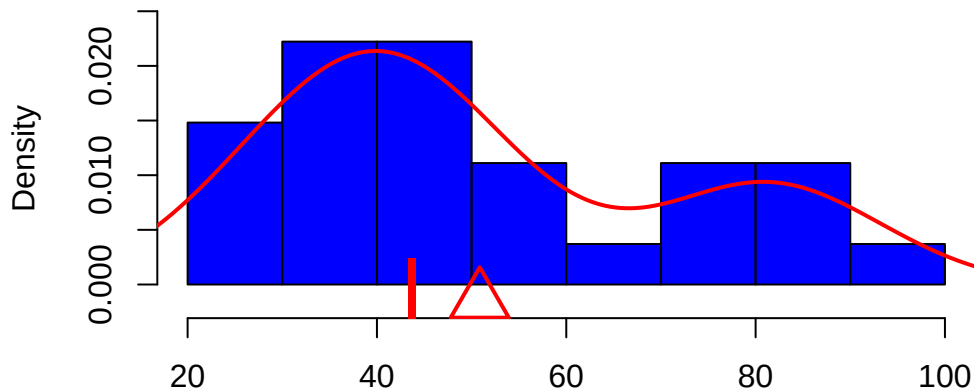
QTM 220

Supreme Court Justices

Load the provided dataset “EMdata.csv”

- This data is on 27 justices from the Warren ('53 - '69), Burger ('69 - '86), and Rehnquist ('86 - '05) courts
 - The data can be interpreted as a census for the 1953 - 2005 era.
 - Variables:
 - Justice: last name of Supreme Court Justice
 - CLlib: Percentage of votes in liberal direction for each justice in civil liberties cases
 - party: Political party that nominated the justice (Republican =0, Democrat=1)
 - ur: Justice is a member of an under-represented group, such as a racial or gender minority (under-represented group=1, not in under-represented group=0)
- (a) Create a histogram of the percentage of liberal votes, visually identifying the mean and median.

Histogram of CLlib



% Support for Liberal Position on Civil Liberties Cases (CLlib)

- (b) Describe what the mean and median represent in the context of the CLlib variable for these justices. Which is larger? What does that imply in this context?

SOLUTION

- (c) Write your own function to calculate the standard deviation of CLlib (i.e. not using “sd”) and report it. Add a visual identification of a standard deviation on each side of the mean.

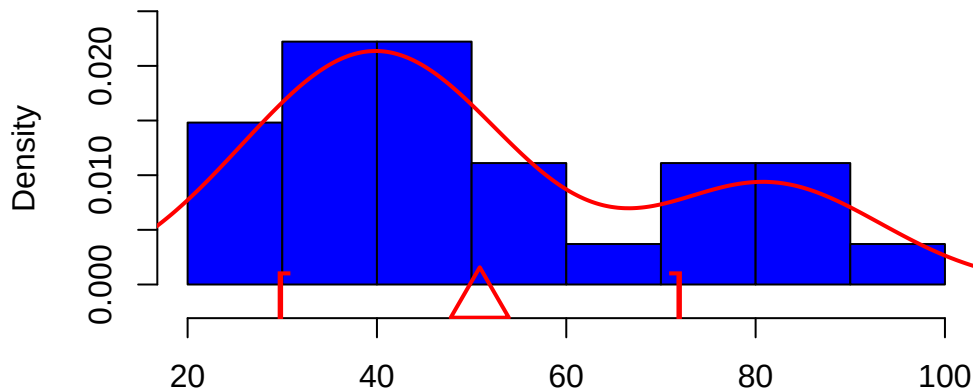
```
y.bar<- mean(CLlib)
s.resid<- rep(0,length(CLlib))
for(i in 1:length(CLlib)){
  s.resid[i] <- (CLlib[i] - y.bar)^2
}
sqrt(sum(s.resid)/(length(CLlib)-1))
```

```
[1] 20.89227
```

```
sd(CLlib)
```

```
[1] 20.89227
```

Histogram of CLlib



% Support for Liberal Position on Civil Liberties Cases (CLlib)

- (d) Calculate the mean of 'ur', whether a justice is a member of an under-represented group. What is the substantive interpretation of this mean?

```
mean(ur)
```

```
[1] 0.1111111
```

The proportion of justices who are 1s, the proportion of justices who are members of an under-represented group.

- (e) Calculate the conditional means and medians of CLlib conditioning on nominating party. Create two histograms of CLlib, one for Republican-nominated justices, one for Democratic-nominated justices. What do the mean and median represent in the context of the CLlib variable for the justices of each party? Which is larger, the mean among Republican justices or Democratic justices? Give a substantive interpretation of this. Which is larger, the median among Republican justices or Democratic justices? Give a substantive interpretation of this. Which difference is larger? What does that mean?

```
mean(CLlib[party==0])
```

```
[1] 44.11333
```

```
median(CLlib[party==0])
```

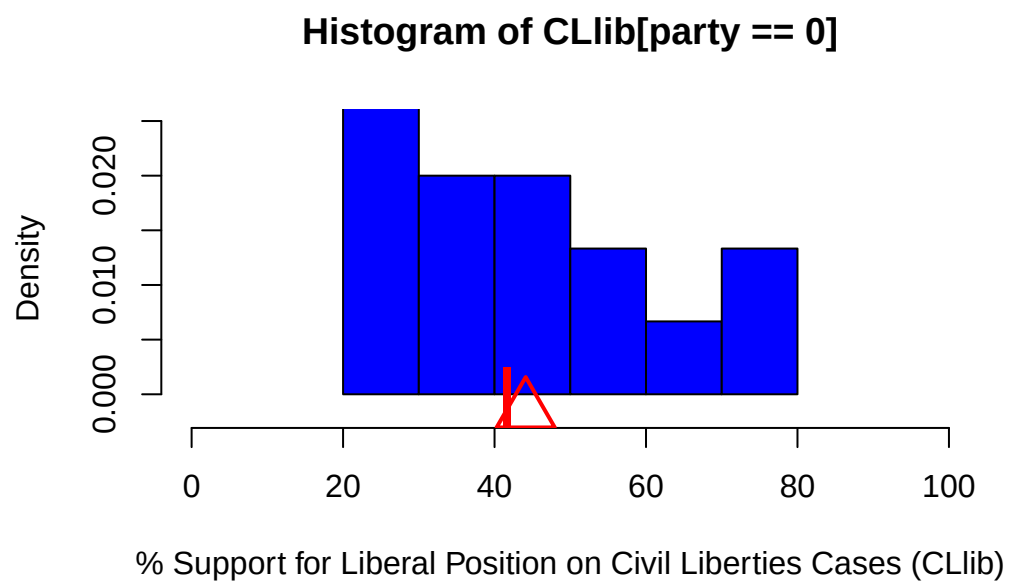
```
[1] 41.7
```

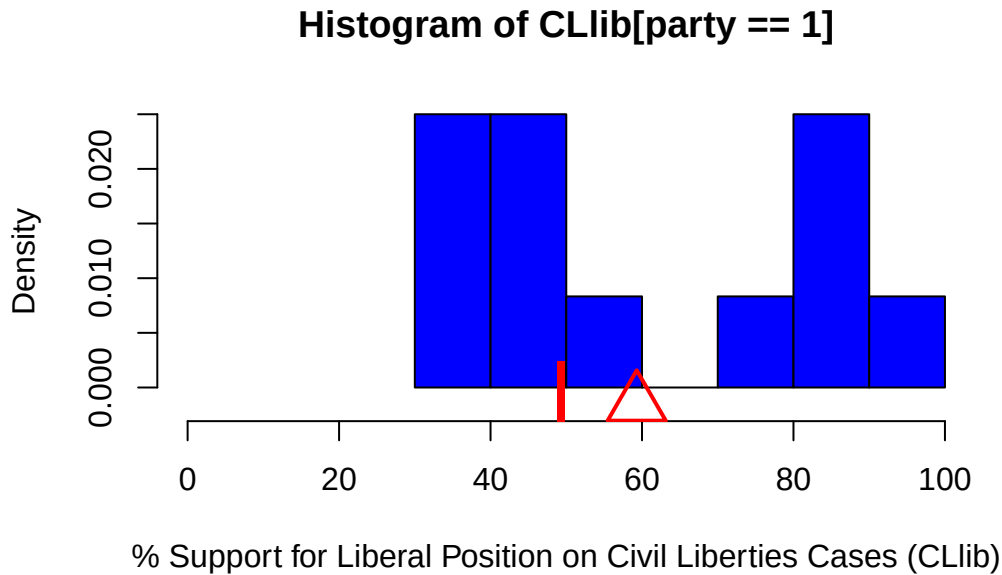
```
mean(CLiblib[party==1])
```

```
[1] 59.3
```

```
median(CLiblib[party==1])
```

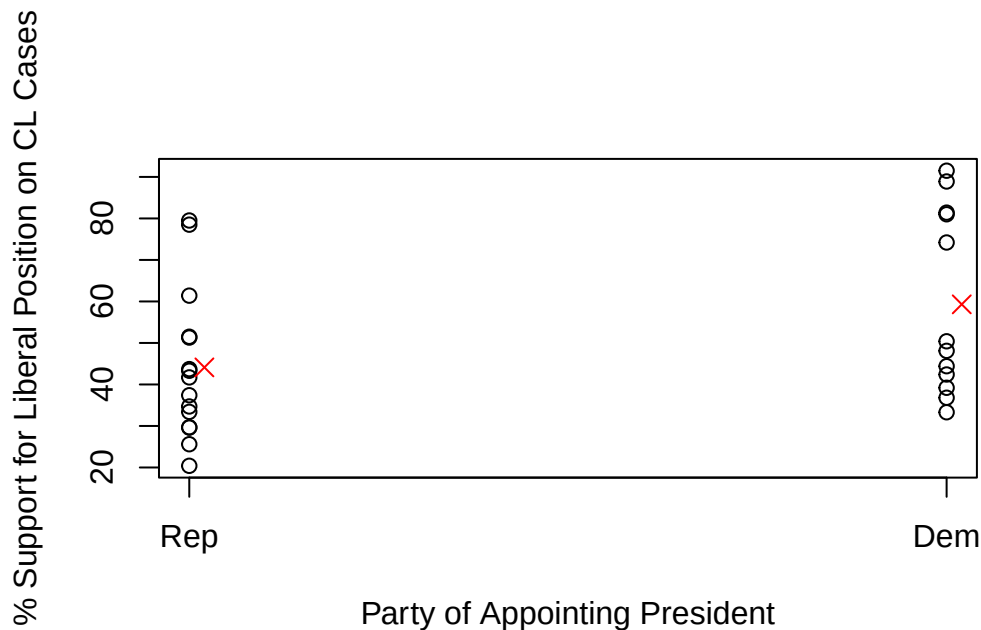
```
[1] 49.25
```





SUBSTANTIVE INT.

- (f) Create a scatter plot of CLlib with the nominating party as the x-axis. Visually indicate the conditional means (conditioning on party) on the plot.



- (g) Using R's `lm()` function, regress CLlib on party. Using `abline()`, add the regression line to your scatterplot. What is substantive interpretation of the intercept and slope of the line in terms of justices for each party?

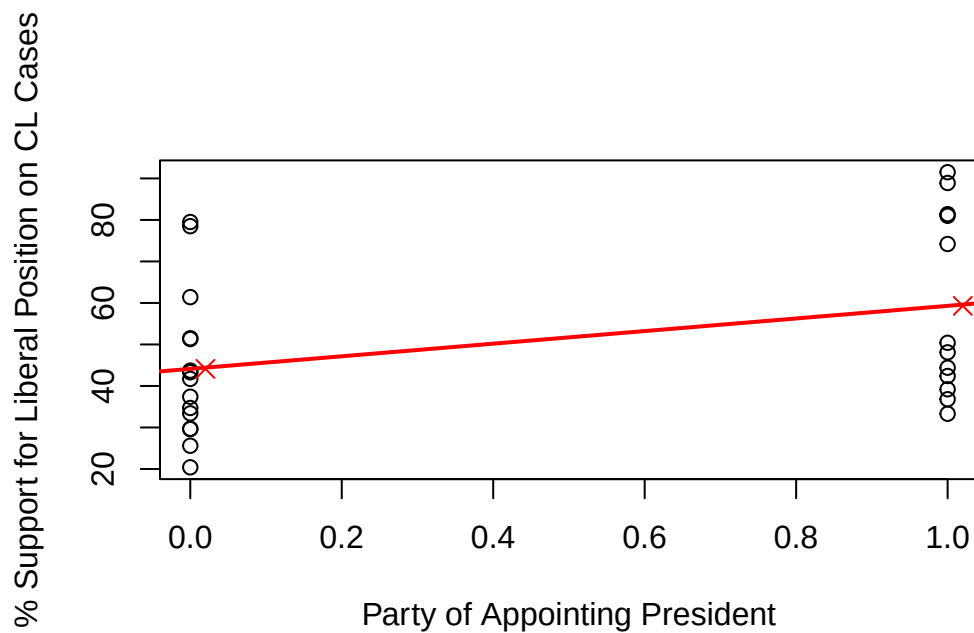
```
lm(CLlib~party)
```

Call:

```
lm(formula = CLlib ~ party)
```

Coefficients:

(Intercept)	party
44.11	15.19



SUBSTANTIVE

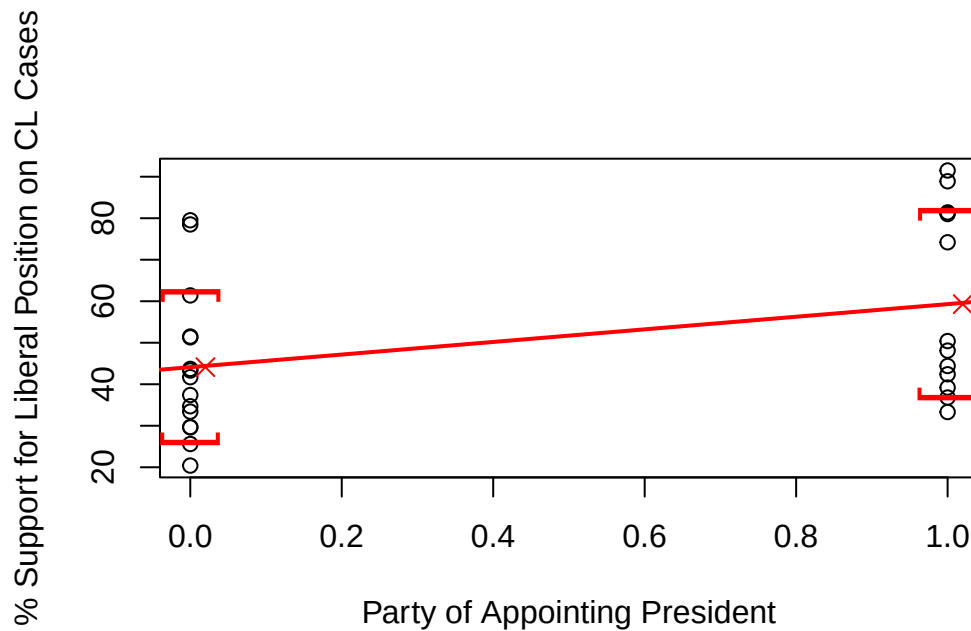
- (h) Calculate the conditional standard deviations of CLlib, conditioning on party. Add a visual representation of the conditional standard deviations to your scatterplot.

```
sd(CLlib[party==0])
```

```
[1] 17.76485
```

```
sd(CLlib[party==1])
```

[1] 22.14177



- (i) Create a scatterplot of justices with under-represented group membership as the y-axis and party as the x-axis. Add the conditional means and standard deviations to the plot (conditioning on party). Using `lm()`, regress under-represented group membership on party and add the regression line to your plot using `abline()`. What is the substantive interpretation of the intercept and slope of the line in terms of justices for each party?

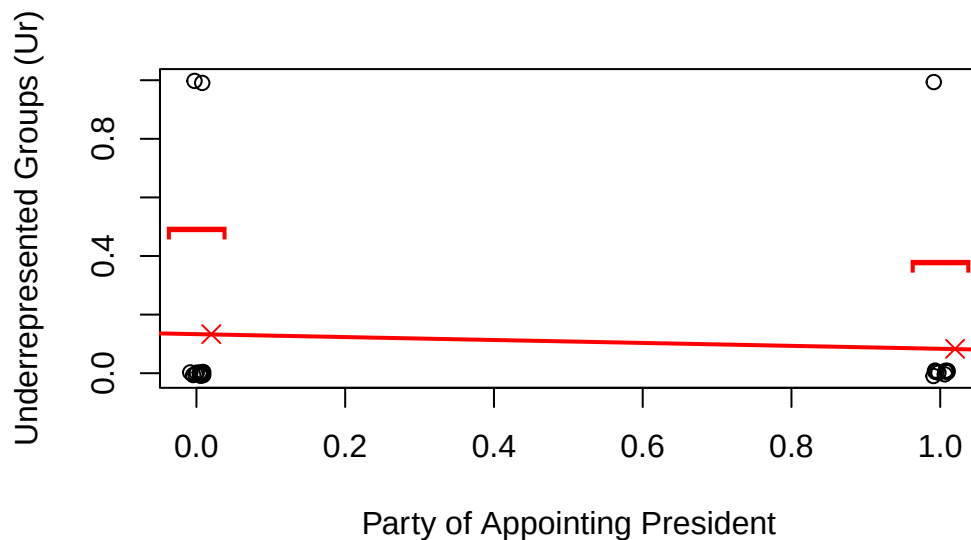
```
lm(ur~party)
```

Call:

```
lm(formula = ur ~ party)
```

Coefficients:

(Intercept)	party
0.1333	-0.0500



SUBSTANCE

Matrix Algebra and Least Squares

- (a) Let Y be the $n \times 1$ vector of our outcome variable and X be the $n \times 2$ matrix that concatenates our independent variable of interest with a row of 1s. $\hat{\beta}$ is a 2×1 vector.

$$Y = \begin{bmatrix} y_1 \\ y_2 \\ y_3 \\ \vdots \\ y_n \end{bmatrix}$$

$$X = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & x_1 \\ 1 & x_2 \\ 1 & x_3 \\ \vdots & \vdots \\ 1 & x_n \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\hat{\beta} = \begin{bmatrix} \hat{\beta}_0 \\ \hat{\beta}_1 \end{bmatrix}$$

Define r as the $n \times 1$ vector of residuals as given by $Y - X\hat{\beta}$

Using matrix algebra, show that $(Y - X\hat{\beta})'(Y - X\hat{\beta})$ yields the sum of squared residuals.

- (b) Using matrix algebra and $\frac{\partial}{\partial \hat{\beta}}$, show that $\hat{\beta} = (X'X)^{-1}X'Y$ minimizes the sum of squared residuals (assuming that $X'X$ is invertible.)

(c) Let $Y = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ 0 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}$ and $X = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$

Using matrix algebra, calculate $(X'X)^{-1}X'Y$.

(d) In R, create a dataframe $y = c(1, 1, 0, 1)$ and $x = c(1, 0, 0, 1)$. Calculate the conditional means of y when $x = 1$ and when $x = 0$

```
y<- c(1,1,0,1)
x<- c(1,0,0,1)
df<- data.frame(y,x)
mean(df$y[x==0])
```

```
[1] 0.5
```

```
mean(df$y[x==1])
```

```
[1] 1
```

(e) Using R's `lm()` function, regress y on x .

```
lm(y~x)
```

Call:

```
lm(formula = y ~ x)
```

Coefficients:

(Intercept)	x
0.5	0.5